Others were largely incompetent and some had simply taken advantage of the Bolshevik willingness to clothe and feed them – one graduate of the Tashkent school had reportedly succeeded in smuggling a large sum of money into India meant for the purpose of Communist propaganda. Instead, the man had used the money to build himself a house.[149]

Together with the vigilance of its border officials, another reason the Indian government was so successful at detecting any revolutionary infiltration into the country was that it was kept well informed intercepting Roy's mail. Indeed, his letters had 'been an unfailing source of information of proved accuracy as to the movements of men, money and literature'.[150] The British government had also been regularly decoding encrypted Soviet and Comintern communications[151] and monitoring Communist radio traffic,[152] while the Indian police force were adept at infiltrating any germinating Communist organisations within India. It was through such vigilance that by 1923 Roy's main agents in India had all been arrested and tried in what became known as the Cawnpore Conspiracy.[153] Indian intelligence reports also emphasised the fact that India was just not ready for Communism: 'Roy's main adversary was not just the Indian police, but also Gandhi. Gandhi from 1919 onwards had gained such a commanding position over the Indian nationalist movement that it proved almost impossible for the Communists to gain a foothold within it.'[154]

Indeed, it would not be until 1925 that an Indian Communist Party would be founded on Indian soil.[155] Just as the nationalism of Reza Khan and emir Amanullah had kept Bolshevism at bay in Persia and Afghanistan, so too did Gandhi do the same in India. Thus, in contrast to MI5 and Special Branch in Britain, who were 'gripped by a deep anxiety' in regards to Bolshevism, the DCI proved a calming influence on the Indian government.[156] One historian has demonstrated how the IDCEU in London suffered from 'imperial paranoia', seeing isolated incidents of anti-British agitation as part of a vast conspiracy against the empire.[157] Another has argued that individuals in intelligence and defence in London often inflated the Bolshevik threat, as opposed to in India where there was 'recognition that the threat might easily be contained, given the ineptitude and greed of many Communist agents'.[158] This confidence in its understanding of, and ability to combat, Bolshevism goes a large way to explaining why the